

01

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Analogy, symbol, negation, cognitivist/non-cognitivist accounts, Ayer, Braithwaite, Wittgensteinian use, Tillich and Advaitic language are CORE PAPER II.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Scotus, Maimonides, Flew–Hare–Mitchell, speech acts and symbol-to-mysticism are PYQ-TRIGGERED CORE.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not merge semantic mode with truth-aptness.

ANSWER LINE: [FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

02

Contemporary technology anchor — semantic fidelity in sacred-text translation [SUPPORTING]

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Fact: An ICML 2026 paper on Sanskrit–English translation reports that purely statistical generation can cause semantic drift in culturally embedded and ritual concepts, and proposes dictionary, morpho-syntactic and glossary-grounded decoding to preserve sacred entities and terminology.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Inference: This contemporary translation problem illustrates a core philosophical point: religious meaning is not exhausted by word substitution.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Context, use, symbolic reference and a tradition’s conceptual grammar affect what an utterance means, though an AI translation benchmark does not settle whether the original claims are truth-apt.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ Inference: This contemporary translation problem illustrates a core philosophical point: religious meaning is not exhausted by word substitution.

ANSWER LINE: □ Fact: An ICML 2026 paper on Sanskrit–English translation reports that purely statistical generation can cause semantic drift in culturally embedded and ritual concepts, and proposes dictionary, morpho-syntactic and glossary-grounded decoding to preserve sacred entities and terminology.

03

Visual gateway — never merge the two axes

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Mnemonic — two axes: "HOW (Analogy/Symbol/Negation) × WHETHER (Cognitive/Non-cognitive)." Analogy & symbol rescue meaning; the cog/non-cog debate is about factual truth.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Master verdict: Religious utterances are often assertoric, symbolic and performative together; a mixed account preserves realist intent while acknowledging that transcendence requires non-literal modes of predication.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

A symbol (unlike a mere sign) participates in the reality it points to and "opens up levels of reality otherwise closed".

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

So "good" applies proportionally, truly but not identically. → preserves meaning without anthropomorphism.

ANSWER LINE: Analogy preserves ordered similarity, symbol mediates participation and negation removes creaturely limitation; each seeks meaningful reference without literal anthropomorphism.